recruiters dupe prospective emigrants. Public-sector jobs are often reserved for the locals because of which most Indian immigrants work in the private sector, where abuse over terms of employment is more rampant. In economic downturns, the chorus against the migrant grows as nativist policies kick in. For instance, in 2011, Saudi Arabia launched the *nitaqat* policy to incentivize firms to hire more native workers. The Gulf states have consistently followed a policy of 'separation' rather than 'assimilation'.[50]

Yet, the vast wage differential between India and the *Gelf*, as it is called in Kerala, is attractive enough for migrants to consider the option at least once in their lives. In the past decade, the locus of emigration to the Gulf shifted from south India to the north, and the Bhojpuri-speaking tracts of eastern Uttar Pradesh and western Bihar once again dominate annual labour flows outside India, much like they did a century and a half ago.[51] The billions of dollars of remittances from the Gulf that once touched the west coast of India has finally made its way to the Ganga. Reynolds could not have possibly anticipated the chain of events that he had helped trigger.

From Buddha Singh to Sucha Singh

Our tour of the overseas Indian world has three final stations: Oceania, East Asia and Latin America. In the early 19th century, a small trickle from India headed down under to Australia in Oceania as labourers and convicts. In the 1830s, as the first batch of 'hill coolie' indenture migrants were sent to Mauritius, a small batch of Dhangar labourers from Chhota Nagpur were also taken to New South Wales in Australia in 1837.[52] In the late 19th century, the camel trade between Australia and India opened up and Indian cameleers from the north-west were brought in to accompany expeditions and pastoral ventures in the deserts of Australia. The Indian population rose to nearly 5000 by the end of the 19th century, and this development along with other non-white immigration led to a major racial backlash. As in the USA and Canada, Australia passed an Immigration Restriction Act in 1901, known as the White Australia policy, effectively barring Indian migration